

TELESHIM FEEDBACK SCHEDULED TASK

Campaign-specific persistence through a ten-minute task targeting ProgramData.

HUNTING**CONFIDENCE: HIGH**

TELESHIM

Hunt for the exact scheduled-task persistence construction documented by the source.

POST-COMPROMISE ACCESS**SCHTASKS /CREATE****FEEDBACK TASK****10-MINUTE RECURRENCE****PROGRAMDATA PAYLOAD****REPORT DATE****22 July 2026****VERSION****v2.0****PRIMARY TELEMETRY****Microsoft Defender XDR ·
DeviceProcessEvents****ATT&CK / SCOPE****T1053.005 · T1574.002**

Independent defensive research. Source facts, analytical assessment, assumptions and detection logic are intentionally separated. Every query requires environment-specific validation.

01

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision-grade summary for threat research, detection engineering and SOC operations.

ASSESSMENT

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

TELESHIM Feedback Scheduled Task

Zscaler ThreatLabz captured an operator creating a scheduled task named Feedback every ten minutes to execute a payload under ProgramData.

WHY IT MATTERS

Operational detection value

The complete command construction is highly specific and source-supported, but the task name, cadence and payload path are attacker-controlled artifacts.

High 01

ANALYTICAL CONFIDENCE



Focused 02

TELEMETRY COVERAGE



Hunting 03

OPERATIONAL READINESS



SOURCE-CONFIRMED FACT

Documented behavior

Captured activity used schtasks with /create, a ten-minute recurrence, the task name Feedback and a ProgramData target.

ANALYTICAL ASSESSMENT

Interpretation

The full intersection should be useful for hunting; generic scheduled-task or ProgramData rules would introduce substantially broader overlap.

DETECTION ASSUMPTION

Required condition

Command-line telemetry preserves switches, spacing and quoting sufficiently for contains-based matching.

Evidence boundary

It does not identify task creation through COM/API, prove payload maliciousness or detect changed names, cadence or paths.

02

THREAT MECHANICS

Behavioral decomposition and observable evidence boundaries.

ATTACK FLOW



STAGE-BY-STAGE DETECTION VALUE

STAGE	BEHAVIOR	EVIDENCE EXPECTATION	USE
01	Post-compromise access	Supporting process, file, identity or application context must be collected and correlated.	Context / enrichment
02	schtasks /create	Supporting process, file, identity or application context must be collected and correlated.	Context / enrichment
03	Feedback task	Captured activity used schtasks with /create, a ten-minute recurrence, the task name Feedback and a ProgramData target.	Primary anchor
04	10-minute recurrence	Supporting process, file, identity or application context must be collected and correlated.	Context / enrichment
05	ProgramData payload	Supporting process, file, identity or application context must be collected and correlated.	Context / enrichment

Observable core

A match indicates the complete campaign artifact intersection in a process command line.

Non-observable boundary

It does not identify task creation through COM/API, prove payload maliciousness or detect changed names, cadence or paths.

TELEMETRY & EVIDENCE MODEL

Minimum data contract required for a defensible implementation.

DATA CONTRACT

PRIMARY DATA SOURCE

Microsoft Defender XDR · DeviceProcessEvents

The primary platform is selected because it observes the strongest source-supported behavior with the most direct event relationship.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

A match is an investigative lead.

It does not identify task creation through COM/API, prove payload maliciousness or detect changed names, cadence or paths.

REQUIRED FIELD CONTRACT

TIER	DATA	PURPOSE	RELIABILITY
REQUIRED	Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName, AccountName, SHA1, ReportId	Core filtering, grouping and investigation output.	Documented schema; population must be verified.
OPTIONAL	Signer, hash, prevalence, file origin, software inventory, device group.	Benign separation and prioritization.	Environment-dependent.
ENRICHMENT	Threat intelligence, change windows, asset criticality and identity context.	Disposition and escalation.	Integration-dependent.

Completeness

Confirm table coverage, retention, field population and event latency before measuring prevalence.

Normalization

Validate case, path, quoting, URI encoding and command-line preservation against raw events.

Visibility gap

Artifact mutation evades the hunt; broadening each condition would reduce specificity.

04

DETECTION LOGIC

Source-grounded implementation with explicit assumptions and outcome boundaries.

HUNTING

DETECTION OBJECTIVE

Hunt for the exact scheduled-task persistence construction documented by the source.

IMPLEMENTATION STATUS

Hunting - Untested implementation sketch

Syntax and schema are documented; local execution, field population and false-positive performance are not established.

KQL · DEMONSTRATIVE

```
// Title: TELESIM Feedback Scheduled Task in ProgramData
// Status: Hunting query - campaign-specific artifacts
// Confidence: High
// Platform: Microsoft Defender XDR / Microsoft Sentinel with MDE tables
// Telemetry: DeviceProcessEvents
// Purpose: Hunt for the exact scheduled-task persistence construction observed
// by Zscaler ThreatLabz in the TELESIM-related campaign.
// ATT&CK: T1053.005, T1574.002
// Limitation: Task name, recurrence and payload path are attacker-controlled.

DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName =~ "schtasks.exe"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/create"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/sc minute"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/mo 10"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/tn \"Feedback\""
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/tr"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains @"\\ProgramData\\"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, AccountName,
  ProcessCommandLine,
  InitiatingProcessFileName,
  InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
  SHA1, ReportId
```

What a match means

A match indicates the complete campaign artifact intersection in a process command line.

What a match does not prove

It does not identify task creation through COM/API, prove payload maliciousness or detect changed names, cadence or paths.

05

TRIAGE & INVESTIGATION

Evidence-led workflow for defensible disposition.

SOC WORKFLOW

NUMBERED WORKFLOW

- 01

Confirm the match.
Review the raw event, timestamp, entity relationship and exact matching fields.
- 02

Establish legitimacy.
Identify the software or change owner, expected path, signer and authorized maintenance window.
- 03

Reconstruct origin.
Pivot to process, file, identity, network or application events before and after the match.
- 04

Measure prevalence.
Compare hashes, paths, commands, users and devices across the retained fleet.
- 05

Document confidence.
Separate confirmed evidence, inference, assumptions and unresolved gaps.

DECISION MODEL

Approved context → tune narrowly

Known owner, expected software path and repeatable behavior can support a documented exclusion.

Unknown context → deepen review

Rare or risky context without corroboration remains suspicious or insufficient evidence.

Corroborated activity → escalate

Malicious follow-on process, file, network, persistence or identity evidence supports incident escalation.

Host

Coverage, exposure, recent changes and neighboring alerts.

User

Session, intent, role and authorization context.

Process

Parent, child, path, command, signer and original filename.

File

Hash, signature, origin, prevalence and creation timeline.

Network

DNS, proxy, TLS and destinations following the event.

Identity

Sign-ins, token use, privilege and resource access.

OUTCOME	EVIDENCE PROFILE	ACTION
Benign	Approved and repeatable behavior with strong ownership.	Document and tune narrowly.
Suspicious	Risky context without decisive malicious corroboration.	Deepen endpoint or application review.
Likely malicious	Source-compatible match plus corroborated malicious activity.	Escalate incident response.
Insufficient evidence	Missing telemetry or unresolved ownership.	Retain evidence and validate gaps.

06

FALSE POSITIVES & VALIDATION

Operational controls required before alerting.

QUALITY GATE

FALSE-POSITIVE MATRIX

SCENARIO	LIKELIHOOD	TUNING ACTION
Copied administrative scripts	High	Review owner, path, signer, prevalence and change context before exclusion.
Software deployment tests	High	Review owner, path, signer, prevalence and change context before exclusion.
Security simulation	Med	Review owner, path, signer, prevalence and change context before exclusion.
Legacy maintenance tasks	Med	Review owner, path, signer, prevalence and change context before exclusion.

Baseline plan

- Run retrospectively over a representative retention window.
- Measure volume by device, user, process, path and software owner.
- Inspect recurring legitimate patterns before adding exclusions.
- Preserve raw examples for peer review.

Validation procedure

- Confirm every required field against raw events.
- Execute only safe, authorized lab or historical validation.
- Compare query output with endpoint or application ground truth.
- Record success, rejection and sensor-failure criteria.

PROMOTION GATE

Hunting

Source-grounded hypothesis.

Candidate

Schema and baseline complete.

Production

Measured precision and runbook.

Optimized

Stable feedback loop.

Promotion criteria

Known alert volume, documented exclusions, representative validation, triage ownership, data-quality monitoring and measurable precision.

Failure condition

Artifact mutation evades the hunt; broadening each condition would reduce specificity.

07

ATT&CK, CONCLUSION & REFERENCES

Coverage statement, residual risk and document control.

CLOSURE

COVERAGE MAPPING

MAPPING	COVERAGE STATEMENT	BOUNDARY
T1053.005 · T1574.002	Partial behavioral or campaign-artifact coverage of the source-supported observable.	It does not identify task creation through COM/API, prove payload maliciousness or detect changed names, cadence or paths.

ANALYST CONCLUSION

Assessment, not certainty

The complete construction is assessed as a high-confidence campaign hunting lead, not a durable technique-wide production rule.

Residual risk

Artifact mutation evades the hunt; broadening each condition would reduce specificity.

REFERENCES

- 1. Targeted Attack on Government Entities in the Middle East - Part 1: <https://www.jzscaler.com/blogs/security-research/targeted-attack-government-entities-middle-east-part-1>
- 2. DeviceProcessEvents table in the advanced hunting schema: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table>

DOCUMENT CONTROL

VERSION	DATE	STATUS	OWNER
v2.0	22 July 2026	Hunting	Detection Engineering

Change summary

Migrated to the permanent Threat Research Editorial HTML master; technical query and evidence classification preserved.

Publication control

No customer data, credentials or environment-specific internal indicators are included. URLs are defanged in the publication artefact.